# John de la Garza

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Systems Engineer with a passion for programming, discovery, and problem solving. I have worked on things from low-level code to distributed systems and everything in between.

Over the last year I have started using AI tools more frequently for large parts of the software development process. For example: RFCs, specifications, test plans, implementation. As well as debugging and root cause analysis for issues that span many systems.

## SKILLS

- **domain:** Linux, distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, backend
- **language:** Python, Go, SQL, Rust, Bash, C, Perl, Lua, JavaScript, Ruby, Lisp
- **technology:** AWS, Kubernetes, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Nginx, Flask, WebSockets, SQLAlchemy, Netbox, FastAPI, Prometheus, Grafana, Django

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Cloudflare, San Francisco, CA, Systems Engineer 6/2024 to 5/2026

- SME for asset ingestion pipelines and Netbox as source of truth, owning plugins and integrations between the two systems.
- Led projects end to end: gathering requirements, writing RFCs, creating specs, test plans, documentation, code review, deployment, monitoring with Grafana, and follow up
- Built a self-service UI component in the Netbox plugin enabling users to create hardware part-number to model-number mappings, eliminating manual spreadsheet-based ticket workflows.
- Automated server data ingestion with a Kubernetes cron job hitting a vendor API, using Pydantic models with strict validation and SQLAlchemy/PostgreSQL constraints before pushing into Netbox via the asset ingestion pipeline, saving colleagues from manual processing.
- Built a two-stage reconciliation pipeline: detect diffs between device-reported state (collected via Kafka from node agents) and Netbox, then auto-resolve approved fields in Netbox per RFC-defined rules.
- Wrote test coverage for all new code and refactored existing code in the Netbox plugin and HAWAI ingestion pipeline, reducing mocking overhead and improving test execution speed.
- Triaged provisioning issues and Airflow DAG failures, performing root cause analysis and routing to the appropriate team for resolution.
- Used AI-assisted development tools (opencode) to direct AI coding agents for feature implementation, code review, test generation, and refactoring, accelerating development velocity across the asset management platform.

### Blackberry, Irvine, CA, Senior Software Engineer 4/2019 to 9/2023

- Led design and development of a REST API backend for an enterprise security product, spanning feature work, bug fixes, deployments, and operations. Development was done mostly in Go and Python.
- First responder for customer-facing incidents, tracking root causes across distributed services and deploying fixes.
- Frequently pair programmed with others that were newer to the job to get them up to speed on using git consistently and learning how to run/develop/debug the different microservices.
- Transitioned several services from Python to Go.
- Used OpenResty/Lua to build a bidirectional WebSocket gateway routing messages between customer devices, Kinesis streams, and internal HTTP microservices via pub/sub.

### Comscore, Portland, OR, Senior Software Engineer 11/2016 to 12/2018

- Worked on a distributed system that counted watched ads and determined who watched them, handling data ingestion, normalization, summarization, and export pipelines.
- Built composable command-line tools that acted as a query language for analyzing incoming data and generating custom reports.

### Idealist.org, Portland, OR, Senior Developer 7/2015 to 7/2016

- Worked on a team creating a REST API that needed to inter-operate with an existing model, database, and messaging system. It provided HTTPS endpoints to allow other systems to post jobs in an automated fashion. This involved doing a deep dive into the code to fully understand the existing architecture.
- Created a new system that allowed customers to bulk post job listings. It was available to the end users as a REST API where they could submit jobs, check status, etc. It was consistent, well-documented, and designed to be discoverable.
- Wrote shell scripts to create a chroot-based sandbox. This provided a reproducible development environment on individual developer computers.

### Rally, Washington, DC, Operations Engineer 6/2014 to 3/2015

- Implemented a git-backed HTTP configuration system using Chef on AWS that auto-published on push, eliminating manual file distribution.
- Created a cron job that pulled down XML data, process them, and insert them into a local database.

### TVplus, Orange, CA, Senior Developer 8/2012 to 1/2014

- Designed and implemented a read/write caching layer for a REST API which was used by a JavaScript front end.
- Designed and implemented a system to daily download XML data that represented TV program schedules for the next two weeks and merge/load them into a local database. This could mean scheduled shows were removed, added, or rescheduled, flagging disassociated content for human review.
- Created a service to edit video files (mute segments, transcode to H.264/AAC) and upload hashes to an audio-matching service, with processing parallelized across multiple cores.
- Set up an LXC-based development environment on a single server to replicate a multi-node AWS production stack.

## EDUCATION

Cal State Fullerton, BA Management Information Systems, Dean's List

## SPOKEN LANGUAGES

English and Spanish